Food Assistance Outlook Brief: Projected food assistance needs in December 2026

June 2026

Burkina Faso	1.0-1.49 million	**750,000-999,999**	less than 5%	*Similar*	**Lower**	Conflict, weather	Crisis (IPC Phase 3)
			In December, needs are expected to be seasonally low as harvests continue to improve households' food availability. Despite relative improvements in security and increased area planted due to the return of IDPs, a decrease in agricultural yields are likely due to anticipated below-average rainfall during the agricultural season, coupled with the impact of the Middle East crisis on fertilizer prices and access. Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected in Karo-Peli and Djelgodji, as market supply and food assistance delivery remain constrained and dependent on military-escorted convoys.				
Central African Republic	750,000-999,999	**750,000-999,999**	10-15%	*Similar**	*Similar**	Conflict	Crisis (IPC Phase 3)
			Crisis (IPC Phase 3) is expected to persist across conflict-affected areas in December despite the main harvests in northern areas, as displacement and disrupted livelihoods limit seasonal improvements in food availability. Insecurity in the northeast, southeast, and northwest continues to restrict access to fields and income-earning opportunities, while high food prices further erode purchasing power.				
Honduras	500,000-749,999	**500,000-749,999**	5-10%	*Similar**	*Similar*	Weather	Crisis (IPC Phase 3)
			Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected to emerge and persist in the Dry Corridor through December, while the rest of Honduras remains in Stressed (IPC Phase 2). Rainfall deficits and above-average temperatures before and during the 2026 El Niño event, as well as elevated input costs, are expected to reduce subsistence production among smallholder farmers, likely resulting in delayed and below-average *primera* and *postrera* harvests.				
Burundi	750,000-999,999	**500,000-749,999**	5-10%	*Similar*	*Similar*	Economy, weather, refugee and returnee influx	Stressed (IPC Phase 2)
			Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are expected in the Imbo Plains, Northern Lowlands, and Eastern Lowlands through December, the last month of the second lean season, driven by exhausted Season B food stocks ahead of Season A harvests, plus continued fuel shortages, high food prices, below-average incomes, and localized economic pressure from the influx of refugees and returnees.				
Mali	1.0-1.49 million	**500,000-749,999**	less than 5%	*Similar*	**Higher**	Conflict, economy, weather	Emergency (IPC Phase 4)
			The harvest is expected to support food availability across southern Mali in December, but elevated transport costs and likely average to below-average production will limit household access to food. In central and northern areas, worsening insecurity, displacement, market disruptions, and reduced purchasing power are further eroding livelihoods. As a result, needs are expected to remain similar to last year (during the onset of the fuel crisis). Crisis (IPC Phase 3) will persist in Ménaka, while Emergency (IPC Phase 4) is now expected in Kidal through December due to severe disruptions to markets and trade.				
El Salvador	100,000-249,999	**100,000-249,999**	less than 5%	*Similar**	*Similar*	Weather	Stressed (IPC Phase 2)
			While the *primera* and *postrera* harvests and seasonal labor will provide some relief in meeting food needs, atypically high temperatures and erratic rainfall have delayed *primera* planting in the Eastern Dry Corridor and caused early planting losses in the Western Dry Corridor, limiting stock replenishment and food access amid high market reliance and prices. Cropping conditions are expected to remain hindered by the expected El Niño event. Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes will persist, with a growing share of poor households in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) across both the Western and Eastern Dry Corridors.				

IPC (Version 3.1) Acute Food Insecurity Reference Table for Area Classification

Minimal (IPC Phase 1)	Stressed (IPC Phase 2)	Crisis (IPC Phase 3)	Emergency (IPC Phase 4)	Famine (IPC Phase 5)
Households are able to meet essential food and non-food needs without engaging in atypical and unsustainable strategies to access food and income.	Households have minimally adequate food consumption but are unable to afford some essential non-food expenditures without engaging in stress-coping strategies.	Households either: Have food consumption gaps which are reflected by high or above-usual acute malnutrition; - or - Are marginally able to meet minimum food needs but only by depleting essential livelihood assets or through crisis-coping strategies.	Households either: Have large food consumption gaps which are reflected in very high acute malnutrition and excess mortality; - or - Are able to mitigate large food consumption gaps but only by employing emergency livelihood strategies and asset liquidation.	Households have an extreme lack of food and/or other basic needs even after full employment of coping strategies. Starvation, death, destitution, and extremely critical acute malnutrition levels are evident. (For Famine Classification, area needs to have extreme critical levels of acute malnutrition and mortality.)

! Indicates area would likely be at least one phase worse without current or planned humanitarian food assistance.

Urgent Action Required

FEWS NET assesses and communicates a "risk of Famine" when there is one or more credible alternative scenarios in which Famine (IPC Phase 5) is likely to occur but is not the most likely acute food insecurity outcome. When multiple credible alternative scenarios exist that would likely lead to Famine, FEWS NET encourages communicating these scenarios when planning for and responding to food crises. Consult FEWS NET's reports to understand alternative scenarios; risk of Famine is not captured in regular food security mapping in order to maintain clarity about the most likely scenario. The IPC follows different guidance to assess a risk of Famine, which can be found here.